

Traction Roadmap: Codefi Farm Financial Planning (12-Month)

Executive Summary

Timeframe: 12 months (Weeks 1–52, with quarterly validation gates)

Primary Goal: Acquire 40–60 paying farm customers (target 50) generating \$54–72K ARR at \$150/month ARPU.

Success Criteria: - Month 2: 40%+ activation (cost entry <15 min) on Cohort 1 (n=5–10) - Month 4: 60%+ scenario quality (outputs match farmer intuition) on full Cohort 1 + early Cohort 2 - Month 6: 60%+ MoM retention + clear channel winner identified (co-op or lender) - Month 12: 40–60 paying customers, 60%+ Month 1–2 retention, <\$500 blended CAC

Constraints: - Budget: \$100–120K Year 1 customer acquisition - Team: 3–4 people (founder + agronomist + engineer + part-time ops) - MVP: Rules-based scenario engine + cost entry + benchmarking by Week 6 - Runway: 18 months at current burn; break-even at 200–230 customers (Month 18–20)

Target Customer Profile

Primary Audience: - Mid-scale commodity farmers (500–5,000 acres, corn/soybean) - Midwest (Missouri, Iowa, Illinois, Indiana primary) - Age 40–60, digitally-forward relative to peers - Currently spending \$200–300/month on fragmented tools (QuickBooks, DTN, co-op services)

Where They Are: - Online: DTN, co-op apps, LinkedIn (agronomists) - Offline: Extension office meetings, farm shows, co-op gatherings

How They Discover: - Word-of-mouth from co-op reps and agronomists (35–45% influence weight) - Lender recommendations (35–40% influence weight) - Trusted neighbor referrals (early adopters)

Decision Triggers: - Recent costly input decision (\$5K–10K+ loss) - Input cost spike (fertilizer, seed, fuel) - Commodity price volatility - Need to defend profitability decisions to lenders

Selected Traction Channels

Primary Channel: Business Development (Co-op Partnerships) — 80% Year 1 Focus - Why: Co-op CAC \$100–160 is viable; agronomist-assisted onboarding creates retention; local trust is Year 1 defensibility - Expected ROI: \$500 blended CAC by Month 12; LTV:CAC 5:1+ target - Phases: MOU setup (Month 1), training (Month 2), soft promotion (Month 3), formal scaling (Month 4+)

Secondary Channel: Direct Sales + Warm Introductions — 20% early (Months 1–3) - Why: Zero-CAC soft launch validates product; problem interviews showed farmers discover via trusted advisors; early quality signal before paid acquisition - Expected ROI: Unknown until Month 4 experimentation; zero CAC in Month 1–3 - Phases: Soft launch (Week 6–7), formal direct + experimental ads (Month 4+), decision point Month 6

Experimental Channel (Month 4+): Speaking + Events + Agronomist Education — \$20K Q2 - Why: Agronomists buy on credibility + live interaction; events amplify co-op marketing; direct feedback loops - Expected ROI: To be tested; dial back if agronomist-sourced CAC >\$800 - Budget: \$5K speaking/webinars, \$5K LinkedIn agronomist targeting, \$10K co-op amplification

Strategic Addition (Month 4 pilot): Lender Partnerships - Why: Lenders are equally trusted advisors (35–40% influence); different member bases = geographic/size diversification - Expected ROI: Target CAC <\$150; if achieved, scale to secondary B2B channel by Month 7 - Budget: \$5–8K Month 4–6 exploration + white-label pilot setup

Quarter 1 Action Plan (Weeks 1–13, Months 1–3)

Weeks 1–6: MVP Development + Co-op Setup (Parallel)

Engineering (Owner: Engineer): - Week 1–4: Rules-based scenario engine, cost entry form, benchmarking module - Week 5–6: Beta polish with internal agronomist testers; feature freeze; production-ready - Deliverable: MVP feature-complete, documented, battle-tested by end Week 6

Business Development (Owner: Founder): - Week 1–2: Draft co-op MOUs; target 2–3 regional co-ops; identify key contacts - Week 3–4: Negotiate terms (white-label pricing, revenue share, agronomist training) - Week 5–6: Finalize MOUs; begin agronomist onboarding coordination - Deliverable: 2–3 signed MOUs by end Week 6

Weeks 6–13: Soft Launch + Formal Co-op Onboarding

Soft Launch (Owner: Founder + Agronomist): - Week 6–7: Recruit 3–5 warm-intro farmers from founder's network + 1–2 agronomist mentors (zero CAC) - Week 8–9: First cohort onboarding; agronomist co-trains cost entry - Week 9–12: 30-day pilot window; farmers run scenarios, validate outputs, seek advisor sign-off - Week 12: Conversion decisions; activation + quality data collected - Deliverable: 3–5 pilot customers by Month 2; early activation signal

Formal Co-op Launch (Owner: Founder + Ops): - Week 8–12: Co-op agronomist training (2–3 sessions per co-op); prepare marketing materials (one-pagers, email templates, promo graphics) - Week 12: Soft promotion to co-op membership; pilot success stories documented - Deliverable: Agronomists trained + marketing assets ready for Month 2 formal promotion

Q1 Milestones: - End Month 1 (Week 4): MVP feature-complete + 2–3 MOUs signed - End Month 2 (Week 8): First soft-launch cohort running scenarios; Cohort 2 recruiting underway - End Month 3 (Week 13): Activation data (Cohort 1) + initial quality signal; 8–12 customers (Cohorts 1 + early 2) targeting conversion

Quarter 2 Action Plan (Weeks 14–26, Months 4–6)

Month 4: Scale Co-op + Begin Experimentation

Co-op Scaling (Owner: Founder + Ops): - Formal membership promotion via co-op channels (email, newsletters, pre-season meetings) - Co-op contests/incentives (\$3–5K budget: e.g., "best margin improvement" prizes) - Agronomist upsell training (how to position tool to hesitant farmers) - Goal: 2–3% membership adoption; target 15–20 new customers from co-ops

Experimental Channels Launch (Owner: Founder): - Speaking: 1–2 extension office meeting presentations on scenario planning (\$2–3K) - Webinars: Co-brand 1–2 webinars with co-ops on input cost modeling (\$2–3K production) - LinkedIn: Begin agronomist-targeted ads (\$3–5K) + organic thought leadership posts - Lender Partnerships: Exploratory calls with 1–2 regional lenders; propose white-label pilot - Budget: \$20K allocated across channels (see Budget Allocation section)

Retention (Owner: Agronomist): - Month 2–4 cohort success tracking: margin improvements, decision outcomes - Case study development from early wins (lender-shareable formats) - Monthly scenario refresh emails (commodity price updates, benchmarking refreshes)

Month 5–6: Decision Point Preparation

Data Collection (Owner: Founder + Ops): - Measure co-op CAC actuals (cost per converted customer from each co-op) - Track direct + experimental channel CAC (if any conversions by Month 5) - Monitor Cohort 1 + 2 retention rates (target 60%+ MoM retention) - Assess scenario output quality feedback (60%+ match farmer intuition?)

Channel Decision Trigger (Owner: Founder): - If lender CAC <\$150 + early traction: Prepare case for \$10–15K reallocation or \$20–30K seed injection to accelerate lender channel - If lender CAC >\$150 or no traction: Double down on co-op dominance for Q3 - If direct/experimental CAC >\$800: Dial back paid acquisition; focus on partnership channels

Q2 Milestones: - Month 4: 2–3 speaking slots + 1–2 webinars delivered; lender pilots launched - Month 5: Clear CAC trends emerging across channels; early case studies documented - Month 6: 20–

30 total customers; retention signal clear; channel winner identified; Month 4 quality gate data (60%+ output quality)

Quarter 3 Action Plan (Weeks 27–52, Months 7–12)

Months 7–9: Double Down on Winning Channel

Primary Channel Acceleration (Owner: Founder + Ops): - If co-op dominates: Expand to 5–8 co-ops nationally; increase agronomist training cadence; co-op marketing budget increase (\$15–20K) - If lender emerges: White-label expansion to 3–5 lenders; formal integration testing

Experimental Channels (Owner: Founder): - If direct/event CAC <\$800: Scale speaking tour (\$5–10K) + increase LinkedIn budget (\$5–10K) - If direct/event CAC >\$800: Reallocate to primary channel - Retention-focused: Content series (seasonal planning guides, benchmarking reports) for upsell

Months 10–12: Scaling to Target (40–60 customers)

Acquisition Ramp (Owner: Founder + Ops): - Month 10: Launch paid direct acquisition IF direct CAC data validates <\$800; otherwise stay partnership-focused - Month 11–12: Maximize primary channel through peak season (spring pre-season planning); co-op cross-promotions

Retention + Upsell (Owner: Agronomist): - Monthly retention cohort tracking (30/90/180-day targets: 90%/80%/60%) - Case study library: 10+ documented margin improvements from paying customers - Lender validation loop: Share scenarios with customer lenders; document lender feedback on risk/profitability impact

Q3 Milestones: - Month 7–9: Primary channel scaled; 30–40 customers; retention holding at 60%+ MoM - Month 10: Direct acquisition launched OR confirmed secondary; channel mix finalized - Month 12: 40–60 paying customers; <\$500 blended CAC; 60%+ Month 1–2 retention; proof-of-concept achieved for Series A readiness

Budget Allocation (Year 1)

Q1 (Months 1–3): \$20–25K - Co-op MOU legal/negotiation: \$3–5K - Agronomist training materials + coordination: \$5–7K - Soft launch travel + relationship meetings: \$5–8K - Contingency: \$2–3K

Q2 (Months 4–6): \$35–40K - Co-op scaling (marketing materials, contests, member promos): \$15–18K - Speaking/events/webinar production: \$5–7K - LinkedIn agronomist targeting + content tools: \$3–5K - Lender partnership exploration + white-label setup: \$5–8K - Contingency: \$2–3K

Q3 (Months 7–12): \$35–40K - Primary channel scaling (amplification, expanded partnerships): \$20–25K - Paid acquisition (if validated): \$8–12K - Content/case study production (retention marketing): \$3–5K - Contingency: \$2–3K

Year 1 Total: \$90–105K (within \$100–120K envelope)

Budget Decision Gates: - Month 4: If lender CAC <\$150 + traction, consider \$10–15K reallocation or request \$20–30K seed injection - Month 6: If primary channel CAC >\$600, pivot budget to alternative channels - Month 9: If retention <50%, pause new acquisition; invest in retention improvements

Key Metrics & KPIs

North Star Metric: MRR trajectory (\$6.2K by Month 12 at 50 customers × \$150 ARPU)

Leading Indicators (Monthly Tracking): - New customers by channel (target: 3–4/month Q1, 5–7/month Q2, 8–10/month Q3) - Customer Acquisition Cost by channel (co-op \$100–160, direct TBD, experimental TBD) - Cost entry completion rate within 15 min (target 40%+ by Month 2) - Scenario output quality match (target 60%+ align with farmer intuition by Month 4)

Retention Metrics (Monthly): - Activation rate: % completing cost entry + scenario + decision logged within 2 weeks (target 40%+) - External validation %: % sharing scenarios with lender/advisor (target 40%+; predicts retention) - Retention cohort: % retained at 30/90/180 days (target 90%/80%/60%) - MoM net churn: % month-over-month retention (target 60%+ by Month 6)

Unit Economics: - CAC by channel (co-op, direct, experimental, lender) - LTV:CAC ratio (target 5:1 by Month 12) - Payback period (target <6 months) - Blended CAC (target <\$500 by Month 12)

Review Cadence: Weekly internal (founder + ops); monthly stakeholder reviews; formal gate reviews Month 2, 4, 6

Risk & Contingency

If Month 2 Activation Gate Fails (40%+ <15 min entry): - Trigger: <40% cost entry completion by Week 12 - Root cause: Likely UX friction (form too complex) or data entry burden (manual input too tedious) - Pivot: Redesign cost entry for assisted mode (agronomist co-entry during onboarding call); extend entry time window to 30 min; re-measure Month 3 - Timeline impact: Month 3 gate becomes new activation check; Month 2–3 cohort pauses; Month 4 co-op scaling delays by 4 weeks

If Month 4 Quality Gate Fails (60%+ scenario match): - Trigger: <60% farmers report outputs match their farm reality; outputs don't align with intuition - Root cause: Likely benchmarking data stale, assumptions wrong, or rules engine incorrectly weighted - Pivot: Pause new acquisition; invest 2–3 weeks in scenario output redesign; conduct farmer interviews on output interpretation; re-launch Month 5 - Timeline impact: Month 6 targets slip; co-op scaling pauses; focus shifts to retention of existing cohorts

If Month 6 Retention Fails (60%+ MoM churn): - Trigger: >40% month-over-month churn on any

cohort - Root cause: Likely retention drivers missing (external validation loop not working, lender feedback not integrated, benchmarking not valuable) - Pivot: Implement mandatory lender validation loop; increase agronomist support touchpoints; redesign benchmarking for relevance - Financial impact: Series A becomes mandatory for continued operation; break-even extends to Month 24+

If Lender Channel Underperforms (CAC >\$150): - Trigger: Lender conversion CAC tracking >\$200 by Month 5 - Pivot: Reduce lender budget allocation; reallocate \$5–8K back to co-op amplification - Timeline: Lender channel moves from "secondary scale" to "long-term exploration" post-Month 12

If Direct/Experimental CAC Exceeds \$800: - Trigger: Direct acquisition or events channel CAC tracking >\$1,000 by Month 5 - Pivot: Pause paid ads; dial back speaking budget; focus on organic co-op + lender partnerships - Reallocation: Return \$10–15K to co-op budget; maintain partnership focus through Month 12

Runway Pressure: - If burn accelerates OR revenue timeline slips: Request Series A seed injection by Month 8 (target \$500K–1M) to extend runway and fund scaled acquisition - Fallback: Revert to co-op-only model (lowest CAC); reduce team to founder + part-time engineer; extend Month 12 target to Month 18